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SIMATS ENGINEERING
ASSESSMENT TOOL 3
MCQ Test

COURSE NAME: Computer Networks

COURSE CODE: CSA07

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO3: *Analyze the performance of core network protocols such as TCP, UDP, HTTP, and DNS under varying conditions*

Assessment Tool Weightage: 20%

QUESTIONS:20

Total Marks:20

1. Which TCP mechanism reduces the congestion window by half upon detecting packet loss via duplicate ACKs?
a) Slow Start
b) Fast Retransmit
c) Fast Recovery
d) Tahoe Reset
(BL4)(1)
2. A TCP sender has $CWND = 8$ MSS and $SSTHRESH = 16$. After one RTT with no loss, $CWND$ becomes:
a) 9 MSS
b) 16 MSS
c) 12 MSS
d) 8 MSS
(BL4)(1)
3. Which field in the TCP header is used to implement flow control at the receiver side?
a) Sequence number
b) Acknowledgement number
c) Window size
d) Urgent pointer
(BL4)(1)
4. Nagle's algorithm causes increased latency primarily because it:
a) Disables ACK piggybacking
b) Buffers small segments until ACK arrives

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- c) Reduces CWND on every packet
d) Increases SYN backlog
(BL4)(1)
5. In a high-latency satellite link (600 ms RTT), TCP throughput is primarily limited by:
a) MTU size
b) CWND growth rate relative to RTT
c) DNS resolution time
d) UDP competition
(BL4)(1)
6. UDP is preferred over TCP for DNS queries primarily because:
a) UDP supports fragmentation
b) DNS responses are small and connection overhead is unnecessary
c) TCP cannot use port 53
d) UDP has better error correction
(BL4)(1)
7. A UDP-based streaming application experiences 15% packet loss. The best application-layer mitigation is:
a) Increase UDP buffer size
b) Switch to TCP
c) Implement Forward Error Correction (FEC)
d) Reduce frame rate to 1 fps
(BL4)(1)
8. What is the maximum UDP payload size without IP-level fragmentation on a standard Ethernet link (MTU = 1500 bytes)?
a) 1480 bytes
b) 1472 bytes
c) 1460 bytes
d) 1500 bytes
(BL4)(1)
9. QUIC protocol uses UDP as its transport. The key advantage over TCP-based TLS is:
a) Eliminating IP header overhead
b) 0-RTT or 1-RTT connection setup
c) Removing encryption
d) Native multicast support
(BL4)(1)
10. HTTP/1.1 persistent connections reduce latency by:
a) Enabling UDP fallback
b) Reusing the same TCP connection for multiple requests
c) Compressing HTTP headers
d) Sending requests without waiting for DNS
(BL4)(1)

11. Head-of-line blocking in HTTP/1.1 occurs when:
- a) The DNS server is slow
 - b) A response blocks subsequent responses on the same connection
 - c) TCP CWND drops to zero
 - d) The server rejects pipelined requests
- (BL4)(1)
12. HTTP/2 multiplexing solves HOL blocking at the HTTP layer but not at the:
- a) Application layer
 - b) DNS layer
 - c) TCP layer
 - d) IP layer
- (BL4)(1)
13. Which HTTP status code indicates that a resource has permanently moved and browsers should update bookmarks?
- a) 301
 - b) 302
 - c) 304
 - d) 307
- (BL4)(1)
14. In HTTP caching, the Cache-Control: no-cache directive means:
- a) Never cache this resource
 - b) Validate with the server before using a cached copy
 - c) Cache for 0 seconds
 - d) Disable all caching headers
- (BL4)(1)
15. Which DNS record type maps a domain name to an IPv6 address?
- a) A
 - b) CNAME
 - c) AAAA
 - d) MX
- (BL4)(1)
16. A DNS resolver switches from UDP to TCP when:
- a) The query type is MX
 - b) The response is truncated (TC bit set)
 - c) TTL exceeds 3600 s
 - d) The authoritative server is unreachable
- (BL4)(1)
17. Which attack exploits the UDP-based DNS protocol by sending forged responses with a matching transaction ID?
- a) ARP poisoning
 - b) DNS cache poisoning
 - c) SYN flooding
 - d) BGP hijacking
- (BL4)(1)

18. Setting a very low TTL (e.g., 30 s) for a DNS record primarily increases:

- a) Cache hit ratio
- b) Recursive resolver query load
- c) DNSSEC signature validity
- d) Zone transfer frequency

(BL4)(1)

19. A user browses to a new website. The correct sequence of protocol interactions for the first byte of the page is:

- a) HTTP → TCP → DNS
- b) DNS → TCP handshake → HTTP GET
- c) TCP → DNS → HTTP
- d) DNS → HTTP → TCP

(BL4)(1)

20. Under 20% packet loss, which protocol combination gives the best performance for a real-time multiplayer game?

- a) TCP for game state, HTTP for assets
- b) UDP with application-layer sequencing for game state, HTTP/3 for assets
- c) HTTP/2 for all traffic
- d) TCP with Nagle enabled for all traffic

(BL4)(1)

Code of Conduct:

I _____ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student:

RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION:

Criteria	Weightage (%)	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (Proficient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)
Conceptual Understanding	30%	Demonstrates thorough understanding; answers all questions accurately	Shows good understanding with few errors	Partial understanding; several incorrect responses	Lacks understanding; majority of answers incorrect
Accuracy of Answers	25%	All answers are correct	Most answers are correct with minor mistakes	Some correct answers; frequent errors	Mostly incorrect answers

Application of Knowledge	20%	Correctly applies concepts to problem-based questions	Applies concepts with minor errors	Limited ability to apply concepts	Unable to apply concepts
Time Management	15%	Completes quiz well within time efficiently	Completes on time with minor delays	Requires extra time or rushes through questions	Unable to complete within given time
Question Interpretation	10%	Interprets all questions correctly and responds appropriately	Misinterprets a few questions	Often misinterprets questions	Unable to understand questions

1. Which TCP mechanism reduces the congestion window by half upon detecting packet loss via duplicate ACKs?

Answer: c) Fast Recovery

Justification: Fast Retransmit triggers on 3 duplicate ACKs, but Fast Recovery is the mechanism that halves the congestion window.

2. A TCP sender has $CWND = 8$ MSS and $SSTHRESH = 16$. After one RTT with no loss, $CWND$ becomes:

Answer: b) 16 MSS

Justification: Since $CWND (8) < SSTHRESH (16)$, the sender is in slow start, where $CWND$ doubles each RTT with no loss: $8 \rightarrow 16$.

3. Which field in the TCP header is used to implement flow control at the receiver side?

Answer: c) Window size

Justification: The receiver advertises available buffer space via the Window Size field.

4. Nagle's algorithm causes increased latency primarily because it:

Answer: b) Buffers small segments until ACK arrives

Justification: Nagle's algorithm holds small segments until a pending ACK is received before sending, adding delay.

5. In a high-latency satellite link (600 ms RTT), TCP throughput is primarily limited by:

Answer: b) $CWND$ growth rate relative to RTT

Justification: Throughput is capped by how fast $CWND$ can grow relative to RTT (the bandwidth-delay product effect).

6. UDP is preferred over TCP for DNS queries primarily because:

Answer: b) DNS responses are small and connection overhead is unnecessary

Justification: Small query/response sizes make TCP's connection setup overhead unnecessary.

7. A UDP-based streaming application experiences 15% packet loss. The best application-layer mitigation is:

Answer: c) Implement Forward Error Correction (FEC)

Justification: FEC lets the receiver reconstruct lost data without needing retransmission, ideal for lossy real-time streams.

8. What is the maximum UDP payload size without IP-level fragmentation on a standard Ethernet link (MTU = 1500 bytes)?

Answer: b) 1472 bytes

Justification: $1500 \text{ (MTU)} - 20 \text{ (IP header)} - 8 \text{ (UDP header)} = 1472 \text{ bytes}$

9. QUIC protocol uses UDP as its transport. The key advantage over TCP-based TLS is:

Answer: b) 0-RTT or 1-RTT connection setup

Justification: QUIC combines transport and TLS handshakes to reduce connection setup time.

10. HTTP/1.1 persistent connections reduce latency by:

Answer: b) Reusing the same TCP connection for multiple requests

Justification: Avoiding repeated TCP handshakes for each request reduces overhead.

11. Head-of-line blocking in HTTP/1.1 occurs when:

Answer: b) A response blocks subsequent responses on the same connection

Justification: Responses must be returned in order, so a slow response delays all queued ones.

12. HTTP/2 multiplexing solves HOL blocking at the HTTP layer but not at the:

Answer: c) TCP layer

Justification: All HTTP/2 streams share one TCP connection, so a lost TCP segment still blocks everything.

13. Which HTTP status code indicates that a resource has permanently moved and browsers should update bookmarks?

Answer: a) 301

Justification: 301 Moved Permanently signals a permanent redirect.

14. In HTTP caching, the Cache-Control: no-cache directive means:

Answer: b) Validate with the server before using a cached copy

Justification: no-cache does not disable caching; it requires revalidation before use.

15. Which DNS record type maps a domain name to an IPv6 address?

Answer: c) AAAA

Justification: AAAA records map hostnames to IPv6 addresses (A records are for IPv4).

16. A DNS resolver switches from UDP to TCP when:

Answer: b) The response is truncated (TC bit set)

Justification: The TC bit signals the response didn't fit in a UDP datagram, prompting a TCP retry.

17. Which attack exploits the UDP-based DNS protocol by sending forged responses with a matching transaction ID?

Answer: b) DNS cache poisoning

Justification: Attackers forge responses with a guessed/matching transaction ID to poison resolver caches.

18. Setting a very low TTL (e.g., 30 s) for a DNS record primarily increases:

Answer: b) Recursive resolver query load

Justification: Low TTL forces frequent re-resolution, increasing load on the recursive resolver.

19. A user browses to a new website. The correct sequence of protocol interactions for the first byte of the page is:

Answer: b) DNS → TCP handshake → HTTP GET

Justification: Name resolution must happen before a TCP connection can be opened, before HTTP can be used.

20. Under 20% packet loss, which protocol combination gives the best performance for a real-time multiplayer game?

Answer: b) UDP with application-layer sequencing for game state, HTTP/3 for assets

Justification: UDP avoids TCP's HOL blocking for game state; HTTP/3 (QUIC/UDP) handles asset loading efficiently.

Quick-Reference Answer Sheet

Q	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
Ans	c	b	c	b	b	b	c	b	b	b	b	c	a	b	c	b	b	b	b	b